

Morale (Optional)

Any creature in battle may try to run away or surrender. Characters are never forced to do this; a character always reacts in the way the player wishes. NPCs and monsters, however, may decide to run away or surrender. To handle this situation, each monster is given a **morale score**. Good morale (a high morale score) indicates a willingness to fight on, regardless of the odds. Bad morale (a low morale score) means the monster will panic and desire to withdraw from combat.

MORALE SCORES. A monster's morale score is given in each monster description. This score is a number from 2-12. The higher the morale score, the better the morale. A score of 2 means that the monster will *not* fight. A score of 12 means that the monster will fight to the death without checking morale. Creatures with a morale score between 2 and 12 will need to "check morale" at some time during a battle, as explained below.

HOW TO CHECK MORALE. To check morale, roll 2d6. If the result is greater than the monsters' morale score, the monsters will try to **retreat** or use a **fighting withdrawal** (see **Defensive Movement**, page X24). If the result is less than or equal to the morale score, the monsters will continue to fight.

WHEN TO CHECK MORALE. In general, morale is checked in critical combat situations. Two recommended times for morale checks are:

1. After a side's first death in combat (either monsters or characters).
 2. When 1/2 the monsters have been incapacitated (killed, asleep due to magic, and so forth).
- Monsters that successfully check morale *twice* will fight to the death.

ADJUSTMENTS TO MORALE. Morale can be changed by situations (unless the morale score is 2 or 12). Adjustments to morale may be permanent or temporary. The exact adjustments are left to the DM. A maximum of +2 or -2 is recommended.

RETAINER MORALE. The morale score of a retainer or mercenary is based on the Charisma score of the player hiring him (or her). Retainers must check morale after each adventure. If the morale check is failed, they will not adventure with their employer again. Retainers *do not* need to check morale in combat unless the danger is greater than might reasonably be expected. If a retainer is given a full share of treasure for several adventures, his or her morale score might permanently become 1 higher than the original morale score.

SURRENDER. A character or creature may offer to surrender at any time, however, the opponent need not accept the offer, nor even stop fighting long enough to listen! The DM will handle any talks about surrendering that occur between monsters and characters. Even non-intelligent creatures will usually act reasonably and try to run from hopeless battles. Surrender will usually occur when a morale check is failed, if the defender cannot safely escape.

CHARACTER ATTACKS

Character Class and Level

Roll needed on a 20-sided die to hit listed Armor Class

FIGHTERS*	CLERICS**	MAGIC-USERS	9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2	1	0	-1	-2	-3
normal man			11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	20	20	20
1-3	1-4	1-5	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	20	20
4-6	5-8	6-10	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
7-9	9-12	11-15	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17
10-12	13-16	16-20	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
13-15	17-20	21-25	2	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13

*Also Dwarves, Elves, and Halflings

**Also Thieves

MONSTER ATTACKS

Monster's Hit Dice	Defender's Armor Class														
	9	8	7	6	5	4	3	2	1	0	-1	-2	-3		
Up to 1	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	20	20		
1+ to 2	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	20		
2+ to 3	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20		
3+ to 4	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19		
4+ to 5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18		
5+ to 6	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17		
6+ to 7	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16		
7+ to 9	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15		
9+ to 11	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14		
11+ to 13	2	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13		
13+ to 15	2	2	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12		
15+ to 17	2	2	2	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11		
17+ to 19	2	2	2	2	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10		
19+ to 21	2	2	2	2	2	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9		
21+ or more	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	3	4	5	6	7	8		

A melee or missile fire attack does *not* automatically hit. The chance of an attack hitting or being successful is given as a number between 1 and 20 and is determined by comparing the attacker's level or hit dice to the defender's armor class (AC) on these tables. One table is used when characters (PCs or NPCs) are attacking, and the other is used when monsters are attacking. **Roll 1d20: if the result is equal to or greater than the number indicated by the chart, the attack has been successful.** Unless magical or silver weapons are needed to cause damage, (and not available) a roll of **20** will **always** hit, and a roll of **1** will always **miss**.